TICAD YOUTH DRIVE 2026

Youth Agenda 2055: From Vision to Action

Fourth Session · Mensvic Grand Hotel, Accra, Ghana · 13–14 August 2026



















CONVENED AND ORGANIZED BY

HOSTED IN PARTNERSHIP WITH

Ministry of Youth
Development and Empowerment

PROCEEDINGS

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About the TICAD Youth Drive 2026

Acknowledgements

The African Diaspora Network Japan (ADNJ) and the Africa Asia Youth Nest (AAYN) extend their sincere gratitude to the Government of Ghana, and in particular the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment, for generously hosting the TICAD Youth Drive 2026, and for its steadfast political support in placing the Drive on Ghana's official Youth Month calendar of events.

We gratefully acknowledge the contributions of our core partners and sponsors, including JICA, UNDP, Toyota Tsusho, SMBC, Shibusawa & Company, AnimaxFyb Studios, Creative Studio Academy, and the many other organizations whose support made this Drive possible.

We are especially grateful to the Pan-African Youth Union, the AfCFTA Policy Network, UNECA, the Embassy of Japan in Ghana, the National Youth Authority of Ghana, and the Diaspora African Forum, for their partnership and presence throughout the Drive. Finally, we thank the young delegates themselves, from Ghana, from across the African continent, and from Japan, whose energy, honesty, and willingness to take the stage made this Drive what it was.

We are grateful to Terry Otieno, Policy and Programmes Lead, Africa Diaspora Network Japan (ADNJ), for compiling and editing this report.

Foreword

The fourth TICAD Youth Drive brought together an extraordinary, committed community of young Africans and Japanese, gathered in Accra under a single theme: **Youth Agenda 2055, From Vision to Action.**

Of everything shared across these two days, three points stand out.

First: the vision has become policy, and the policy has become an institution. What began as young people simply being asked what future they wanted has, over eighteen months, become Youth Agenda 2055: The Future We Want, launched at TICAD9 in Yokohama. In Accra, that policy took its next form: the Africa–Japan Youth Alliance, a standing, youth-owned structure with a Council, a Secretariat, and an Advisory Panel already in motion.

Second: this generation is not waiting for permission. Across nearly every session, from the keynote dialogue to the capacity-building floor, the same message surfaced independently, again and again: take action, start small, don't wait for institutions. That convergence, unprompted and unrehearsed, is itself a form of evidence.

Third: the relationship between Africa and Japan is being rebuilt person by person, and generation by generation. Not through aid alone, but through nine years of patient trust-building, through drone businesses started with one borrowed acre, through thirty-five years of one woman's quiet advocacy finally recognised on a stage in Accra. The future this Drive is building is, quite literally, being built by hand.

We are proud to share these Proceedings as a record of what was said, what was decided, and what comes next.

David Kpondehou, Ami Saito, Terry Otieno, & Yuki Yasumiba Co-chairs, TICAD Youth Drive 2026

Organizers' Summary

The TICAD Youth Drive 2026 was convened by ADNJ and AAYN, in partnership with the Government of Ghana, from 13 to 14 August 2026 at the Mensvic Grand Hotel, Accra. It was the fourth in a series of Africa–Japan Youth Drives, and the second to be held on the African continent under the banner of a fully realised policy framework, Youth Agenda 2055: The Future We Want.

The Drive's two headline outcomes were the official launch of the **Africa–Japan Youth Alliance (AJYA)**, a membership-based, youth-owned organization tasked with implementing Youth Agenda 2055's ten action points, and the adoption of the **Accra Declaration**, signed on stage by representatives of the Pan-African Youth Union, AAYN, and ADNJ, carrying the Drive's call to action forward to the African Union, TICAD co-organizers, and global partners including the World Bank, JICA, and UNDP.

Day 1 combined high-level policy dialogue with hands-on capacity building, including sessions on digital skills and AI, entrepreneurship, and storytelling for social change, and closed with a Cultural Night celebrating the diversity of both delegations. Day 2 shifted to an Innovation and Industry Tour, with workshops hosted by Toyota Tsusho Ghana, AnimaxFyb Studios, and Medulla Digital, followed by a city and cultural tour of Accra.

TICAD Youth Drive 2026 in Numbers

285
In person youth delegates

732
People joined the live stream

4th
TICAD Youth Drive

18+
Speakers & moderators

2
Countries hosting the Drive series (Japan & Ghana)

6
Mainstream media outreach: 4 news articles, 1 TV interview, & 1 radio interview

23
Nationalities

2
High schools in cultural exchange: Hiroo Gakuen & Labone Senior

Drive Format

The TICAD Youth Drive 2026 combined a high-level plenary format, welcome remarks, keynote addresses, and a moderated keynote dialogue, with hands-on, interactive capacity-building sessions, storytelling exercises, digital skills training, and small-group facilitation. Day 2 extended the format further into applied, on-site learning through industry visits and a cultural tour, reflecting the Drive's core philosophy: **policy dialogue alone does not build capacity, direct exposure does.**

> *Policy dialogue alone does not build capacity, direct exposure does.*
>
> **- The Drive's core philosophy**



TICAD YOUTH DRIVE 2026

02

Day 1 Programme

13 August 2026

8:00 – 8:50 AM

Arrival, Registration & the Africa- Japan Village

The Drive opened with participant check-in alongside the Africa–Japan Village exhibition space, an informal networking area bringing together African and Japanese youth, policymakers, development partners, and the private sector, accompanied by a cultural performance.

8:50 – 9:50 AM

Welcome Remarks



Speakers: Hon. George Opare Addo Esq (Minister of Youth Development and Empowerment, Ghana) · David Kpondehou (President, ADNJ) · H.E. Hiroshi Yoshimoto (Ambassador of Japan to Ghana) · President Moumouni Dialla (Pan-African Youth Union) · Louis Afful (AfCFTA Policy Network) · Dr. Zuzana Schwidrowski (UNECA, remarks delivered by Mrs. Caroline Obeng)

Hon. George Opare Addo, Ghana's Minister of Youth Development and Empowerment, officially declared the Drive open, setting a tone of partnership over dependency.



> *"Africa does not need Japan's charity. And Japan does not need Africa merely as a market or a source of labor. What we need is partnership."*
> **-Hon. George Opare Addo**



David Kpondehou, President of ADNJ, led the room through the story of how the Drive arrived in Ghana, from the TICAD9 handover of Youth Agenda 2055 to Japan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs, to a conversation with Ghana's President at the TICAD9 closing session, to his own visit to Accra in January 2026.



H.E. Hiroshi Yoshimoto, Ambassador of Japan to Ghana, noted that 2027 will mark 70 years of Japan–Ghana diplomatic relations and 100 years since Dr. Hideyo Noguchi's arrival in Ghana, and shared that over 10,000 participants from 39 countries, including Ghana, are already enrolled in the University of Tokyo's free AI and data science courses under TICAD9's commitment to train 300,000 young Africans.

President Moumouni Dialla of the Pan-African Youth Union, representing 54 countries, called for urgency in capacity building and entrepreneurship.



> *Viva Africa! Viva collaboration, Japan and Africa!*
> **-President Moumouni Dialla**



Louis Afful, Executive Director of the AfCFTA Policy Network, outlined 12 priority service areas through which young people can participate in continental trade, and announced Ghana's new visa-fee waiver for African travellers, with plans to extend AfCFTA integration to the Caribbean diaspora when Ghana assumes the AU chairmanship in 2027.

Dr. Zuzana Schwidrowski, Director of UNECA's Socio-Economic Development Division, could not attend in person; her remarks were delivered on her behalf by Mrs. Caroline Obeng.



> *Young people should not simply be discussed as the future. You are partners in shaping the present* — Dr. Zuzana Schwidrowski, delivered by Mrs. Caroline Obeng

9:50 – 10:05 AM

Keynote Address: TICAD & Youth Action

Speaker: Prof. Mieko Ikegame (Former UN Lead Negotiator and Focal Point for TICAD; Special Adviser to the CEO of AUDA-NEPAD)

Prof. Mieko Ikegame, who spent 33 years at the United Nations and worked across 30 African countries, took the room through TICAD's real origin story: born out of the UN system rather than a bilateral agreement, and built specifically to ensure Africa's own voice led the process.



> *You may think I look Japanese, but I'm a UN person. And if you ask where your heart is, I say my heart is for Africa. Action without vision is nothing.- Prof. Mieko Ikegame*

10:05 – 10:20 AM

Official Launch of the Africa–Japan Youth Alliance (AJYA)

Speakers: Terry Otieno (Policy Lead, ADNJ) · Ami Saito (Co-founder, AAYN)

Terry Otieno and Ami Saito officially launched the Africa–Japan Youth Alliance, the standing structure called for within Youth Agenda 2055. Terry outlined AJYA's operating structure: a Council meeting quarterly, a five-team Secretariat (conferences, outreach, policy support, community management, and fundraising) meeting biweekly, and an Advisory Panel with JICA and UNDP meeting monthly.



> *Let us move beyond dialogue. Let us move towards co-creation. Let us build the future we want, together.*- **Terry Otieno**

> *What we need is a sustainable ecosystem that keeps people connected and working together long after an event ends. This is why we are launching the Africa–Japan Youth Alliance.* -**Ami Saito**



10:20 – 10:30 AM

Musical Performance

Performer: Hirari Sato



Hirari Sato, an award-winning Japanese singer, songwriter, and composer from Niigata, Japan, performed 'Amazing Grace' for the delegation. Hirari was the youngest-ever winner of Japan's Gold Concert at age 9, has performed at New York's Apollo Theater, before the Emperor and Empress of Japan, at the Tokyo 2020 Paralympic Games, Italy's Rossini Opera Festival, St. Paul's Cathedral, and represented Japan at Expo 2025 Osaka.

10:30 – 11:30 AM

High-Level Keynote Dialogue



Theme: Building the Future Together, Africa–Japan Cooperation and Youth Leadership for Inclusive Growth
Moderator: Terry Otieno (Policy Lead, ADNJ)
Panelists: Hiroshi Yokoyama (CEO, AXCEL Africa) · Keitai Tsuchihashi (Director, KAMBANG Farms and Supplies Ltd) · David Kpondehou (President, ADNJ, standing in for Prof. Oussouby Sacko, who was unable to attend due to a flight disconnection) · Jewel Hatta (AXCEL Africa)

The dialogue was structured around two themes. **Theme One, Youth Innovation and Economic Opportunity,** opened with Hiroshi Yokoyama, who built AXCEL Africa after concluding that Japanese companies visiting Africa rarely left lasting impact without someone dedicated to building the bridge.

> *The future of Africa and Japan is not made by big companies, government, and big money alone. It's made by people, one by one, who choose to stand in the empty space and build something together.*
>
> — Hiroshi Yokoyama

Keitai Tsuchihashi continued the theme from the ground level, describing how KAMBANG Farms' drone-spraying business grew from his own frustration sourcing labour in northern Ghana, now delivering 20–30% productivity gains for client farmers.

> *Ghanaians say munica minica, it means I don't have money. But I started this business as a student, with just one plot in an orphanage garden. Even if you don't have money, you can start small.*
>
> -Keitai Tsuchihashi

Theme Two, Bridging Africa–Japan Youth, opened with David Kpondehou, standing in for Prof. Sacko, who shared the origin story of ADNJ itself, born from uniting scattered African associations across Japan, and the nine years of trust-building it took before a Japanese company agreed to a joint venture with him.

> *This trust for young people is very important, the patience and the capacity to understand, it takes time to realise faith.*
>
> -David Kpondehou

Jewel Hatta closed the panel's individual remarks, describing how moving to Ghana at eighteen reframed her view of the relationship entirely,fromone-directional aidtocomplementaryopportunity.

> *Ghana opened my eyes in the way that opportunities and problems are complementary.*
>
> — Jewel Hatta



The floor opened to audience questions, including from Victor of Chibana International Ghana, who pressed Keitai on whether his drone system could integrate weather prediction, and Haruna Muntala, Executive Director of the I4P Foundation, who asked what happens when youth businesses fail.

Moderator Terry Otieno closed the session by inviting each panelist for one final message. **All four, without coordination, converged on the same theme: take action.**

11:35 AM – 12:30 PM

Inspire Us: Passing the Baton to the Next Generation of Youth Leaders

Speaker: Professor Fred Awaah (Board Chairman, National Sports Authority, Ghana)



Professor Fred Awaah shared a career built on repeated setbacks that ultimately compounded into success, from losing his first bid to lead Ghana's students, to losing a Student Loan Trust Fund board seat to a technicality despite winning 76% of the vote, to eventually becoming Secretary-General of the All Africa Students Union. He completed two PhDs, one in Public Administration through the University of Burundi and one in ICT Education through a World Bank scholarship, both largely during COVID-era lockdowns.

> *Failure is an integral part of the success story.*
> - Prof. Fred Awaah

> *If Fred did it, we can also do it.*
> - Prof. Fred Awaah



Segment: Small or Any Beginnings

Speaker: Kotone Sakamoto (Student, Keio University)



Kotone Sakamoto, a 22-year-old Japanese student, shared how a solo, budget trip to Africa two years ago grew into travel across 18 African countries, including hitchhiking from Senegal to Morocco, now living in Benin while teaching Japanese and running a 46,000-follower Instagram account sharing 'real Africa' with a Japanese audience.

> *When you're lost, choose what scares you or what excites you.*
> **- Kotone Sakamoto**

1:30 – 2:40 PM

Youth Voices: Stories Behind Our Communities

Moderator: Prof. Mieko Ikegame
Participating Schools: Hiroo Gakuen School of Music (Tokyo) · Labone Senior High School (Ghana)

An interactive storytelling and dialogue session connecting Ghanaian and Japanese students. Labone Senior High School, founded in 1949 and expanded after independence in 1957 under Dr. Kwame Nkrumah, shared its 75-year history and motto, 'Primus Semper Aurora.' Students described wanting 'to be the voice, the legacy, and the bridge' of the exchange.

Hiroo Gakuen, whose choir is a consistent national gold medallist in Japan, described how a single university lecture on world peace to 900 student volunteers sparked the trip, with 300 students writing letters afterward and a dedicated study group forming ahead of the visit.



> *A screen can't fully capture the warmth of a handshake.*
> **-Hiroo Gakuen team leader**

2:40 – 3:20 PM

Capacity Building: Digital Skills, AI & Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Moderators: Jewel Hatta, Marina Noda
Speakers: Ray Fiifi (Chief Learning Officer, Medulla Digital Academy)

Ray Fiifi introduced Medulla Digital's role as a channel partner for Unity Technologies, whose real-time 3D platform powers a majority of top mobile games and virtual and augmented reality applications. He walked the room through Unity's use in simulation-based training, from excavator operation to smart agriculture, and framed the session around a central tension: Africa's coming youth dividend, set against an AI-driven wave of job automation.

His challenge to the room was to see the disruption as an opening rather than only a threat, to identify where new categories of digital and simulation-based work are emerging, and to position themselves early.

3:25 – 3:55 PM

Organization for Change: Discovering Your Story

Moderator: Yuki Yasumiba (AAYN)
Speaker: Marina Noda (International Development Specialist, Umikaji Link)

Yuki Yasumiba, Co-founder of AAYN, led an interactive storytelling exercise, organizing delegates into small, deliberately mixed-nationality groups to practise sharing their personal stories. Her framing centred on the difference between facts and narrative in driving social change.

> *Facts help you to understand, but stories help people care.*
> **- Yuki Yasumiba**

4:25 – 4:45 PM

Capacity Building: From Vision to Action

Facilitators: Terry Otieno (ADNJ) · Yuki Yasumiba (AAYN)

A closing capacity-building session translating the day's discussions into concrete next steps, bridging the policy conversations of the morning with the practical, hands-on learning of the sessions that followed.

4:50 – 5:20 PM

Reflections, Key Takeaways & Adoption of the Accra Declaration

Terry Otieno and Yuki Yasumiba guided delegates through a reflections segment before moving to the signing of the Accra Declaration. Yuki read the opening paragraphs of the preamble to the room before the signing ceremony began.

President Moumouni Dialla of the Pan-African Youth Union and Ami Saito, Co-founder of AAYN, signed the Declaration on stage on behalf of their respective organizations, with copies also signed by ADNJ representatives.

> *If we are moving together we can arrive. This is the Africa that you want. We have to build it together.*
> **- President Moumouni Dialla, at the signing of the Accra Declaration**

The Drive closed the formal programme with a group photo session, a media corner for press interviews, and open networking among delegates.



TICAD YOUTH DRIVE 2026

03

Day 1 Cultural Night

13 August 2026, 8:00–9:45PM · MCs: Caroline Obeng & Terry Otieno



Evening Programme

After a long first day of policy dialogue and capacity building, delegates gathered for an evening of music, food, and open cultural exchange. MCs Caroline and Terry kept the programme intentionally brisk, mindful that participants had been on their feet since early morning.

The evening opened with a performance from the Sanka cultural troupe, followed by brief opening remarks declaring the Cultural Night officially open on behalf of the TICAD Youth Drive 2026 committee.

Special Remarks: Prof. Mieko Ikegame

Prof. Mieko Ikegame, introduced light-heartedly as the 'mother of TICAD,' opened by joking that she preferred the title 'queen of TICAD,' since she had not yet received permission from Japan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs for the former.

> *Culture, dances, music and songs can unite us all. Music is a universal language of the humankind.*
> **- Prof. Mieko Ikegame**

She noted that 2026 marks the 70th anniversary of both Japan's and Ghana's United Nations membership, and used the occasion to introduce the United Nations Singers, a group of UN staff members, roughly 65 members from about 45 countries, established just two years after the UN's founding. She described the group's practice of performing in national costume and in multiple languages as a living symbol of the UN's own principle: unity within diversity.

> *United Nations singers is a symbol of unity with diversity, which is the principle of the United Nations.*
> **- Prof. Mieko Ikegame**

She introduced that evening's performer, Hirari Sato, as a Goodwill Ambassador for the UN Singers Peace Concert, praising the emotional reach of her voice before inviting delegates to enjoy the evening in the spirit it was intended, several delegates had changed into yukata and kimono for the occasion.

Performance: Diaspora African Forum- Kids in Tourism

The evening continued with a performance from Kids in Tourism, a youth initiative of the Diaspora African Forum (DAFF), an African Union-endorsed nonprofit mission advocating for Africans in the diaspora. The performers were introduced as the grandchildren of DAFF's founder, Her Excellency Ambassador Dr. Erica Bennett.

A young performer, introduced as a former Junior Tourism Ambassador, recited an original poem titled 'Mother Ghana,' personifying the nation and touring its regions, natural resources, festivals, cuisine, and heritage sites, referencing landmarks including Cape Coast Castle, Kakum National Park, and Wli Falls, and paying tribute to President John Dramani Mahama, before the group closed with music and dance.

Special Recognition: The Bridge Builders Award

Following the performance, Ambassador Dr. Erica Bennett, founder and head of mission of DAFF, with over 45 years of experience in diaspora engagement and pan-African cooperation, addressed the room.



> *This kind of bridge, linking the youth from Japan and the youth from Ghana, is exactly what the heads of state want to see.*
> **- Amb. Dr. Erica Bennett**

Ambassador Bennett then surprised Prof. Mieko Ikegame with DAFF's Bridge Builders Award, previously presented to heads of state and to Winnie Mandela, recognising 35 years of Prof. Ikegame's work for Africa across the African Union, the United Nations, and NEPAD.

> *Shehas worked tirelesslyforAfricathroughtheAfricanUnion,throughtheUN,through NEPAD. Shehas servedthiscontinent.*
> **-Amb. Dr. Erica Bennett, presenting the award**

Visibly moved, Prof. Ikegame accepted the award with brief remarks.

> *Thank you foreverybodywhosupportedmeandhelpedme to carry the mission for Africa. Bring the justicetoAfrica, that's my campaign.*
> **- Prof. Mieko Ikegame**

Dinner

Delegates were served dinner using a coupon system, with seating temporarily moved outside to collect food before returning tothe main hall.

Musical Performance: Hirari Sato

Hirari Sato was introduced with a fuller profile: the first Japanese singer to perform her country's national anthem as a soloist at the Tokyo 2020 Paralympic Games opening ceremony, present in Accra as a goodwill ambassador for the UN Singers Peace Concert, and an artist who has used her music to support communities affected by the Great East Japan Earthquake. She shared her personal commitment to peace advocacy as a citizen of the only nation to have experienced atomic bombing, and her ambition to become 'the Stevie Wonder of Japan.'

She performed 'Amazing Grace' followed by an original Japanese composition, then a collaborative performance of a traditional Japanese song with students from Hiroo Gakuen.

Cultural Performance: Labone Senior High School



Labone Senior High School followed with an energetic performance, drawing a strong response from the floor. The performance built on an existing exchange connection between Labone and Hiroo Gakuen students from an earlier visit to Japan.

Cultural Showcase

With the evening running later than planned, MCs opened the floor for an informal cultural showcase, originally intended for songs, poems, or dance from delegates' home countries. With the room slower to volunteer than hoped, the MCs adapted in real time into a casual, good-humoured 'fashion show' format, inviting delegates already dressed in traditional attire to walk forward and share the name, origin, and significance of what they were wearing. The session closed with a full group photograph.

Unity Toast and Closing

The evening closed with a Unity Toast dedicated to fruitful, long-term partnerships between Africa and Japan. MCs thanked delegates for a full day that had begun early that morning, and delivered logistics for Day 2: departure by bus from the Mensvic Grand Hotel at 8:00 AM sharp, specified as Japan time to avoid ambiguity, a city tour beginning at 1:30 PM, and Drive-branded t-shirts distributed to all participants joining the morning and afternoon activities.



04

Day 2 Programme

14 August 2026 · Innovation & Industry Tour

8:30 AM – 12:00 PM

Innovation Workshop: Youth at the Centre of Industrial Innovation

Delegates split across three parallel innovation sessions hosted by Drive sponsors:

Toyota Tsusho Ghana

30 PARTICIPANTS

Facilitated by Joseph Akwasi, with Ami as team coordinator.

AnimaxFyb Studios

20 PARTICIPANTS

'From Vision to Action in the Creator Age'. Team coordinators Angela and Caroline, with an 8:00 AM departure.

Medulla Digital Office

31 PARTICIPANTS

A masterclass in cybersecurity and automation, coordinated by Caroline.

1:00 – 5:00 PM · 100 participants

City and Cultural Tour

After the individual lunch session, delegates joined a guided tour of Accra's culture and history, visiting the Kwame Nkrumah Memorial Park, the National Museum of Ghana, the Accra Arts Centre, and Black Star Square, closing the Drive with a direct experience of the city that hosted it.





Photo Gallery







Photographs link:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/17cebrx4sByQWSbSgspxGfI_IcCW1zjSL?usp=drive_link







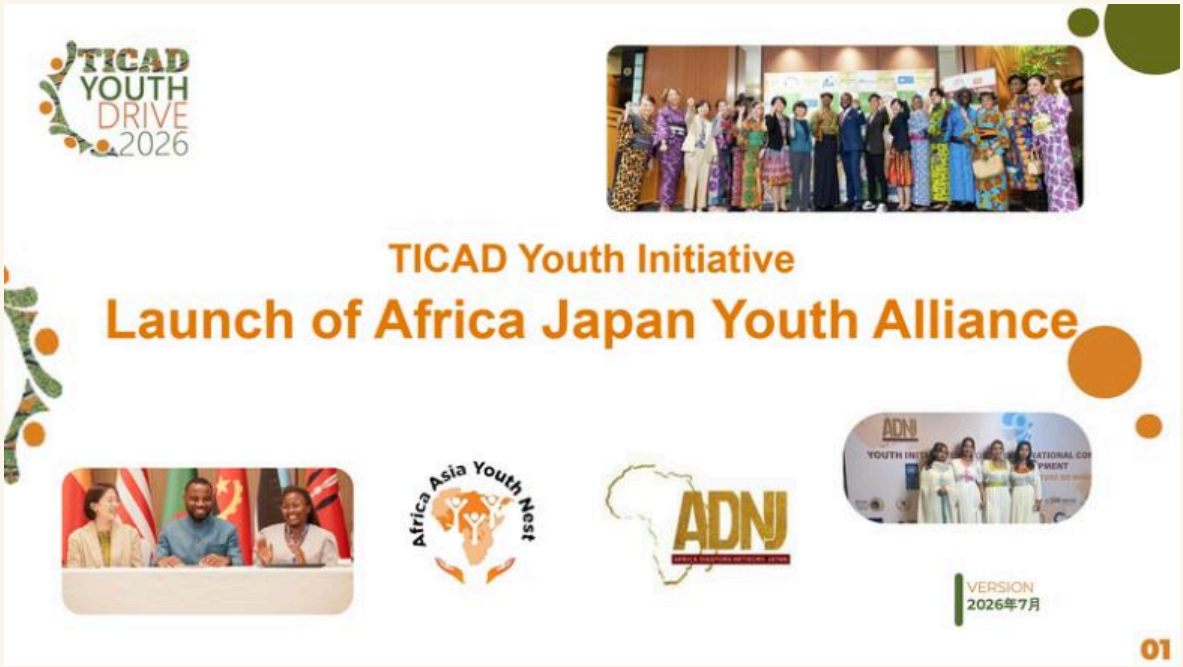

05

Outcomes of the Drive

The Africa–Japan Youth Alliance (AJYA)

The Africa–Japan Youth Alliance is a new, youth-owned, youth-run organization, formally launched at the TICAD Youth Drive 2026. It is membership-based, open to individuals and organizations from anywhere in the world who share its vision.

AJYA's mandate is to carry forward the ten action points of Youth Agenda 2055, spanning inclusive education, youth health and wellbeing, economic empowerment and entrepreneurship, peace, security and youth participation in decision-making, youth mobility and exchange, social cohesion, and climate resilience and sustainability.



05

Outcomes of the Drive





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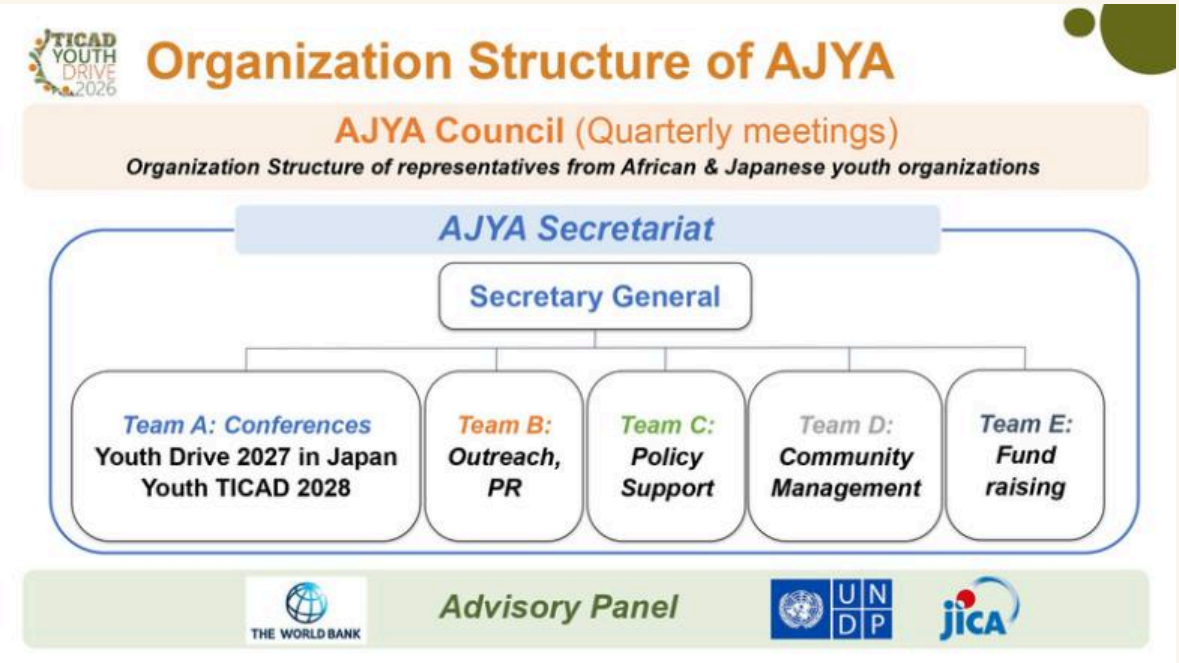
Outcomes of the Drive





05

Outcomes of the Drive



Mainstream Media Coverage

1. **Livestream TICAD Youth Drive 2026 Ghana:** https://www.youtube.com/live/h0JCTr1-yug?si=OisJwyZXyJCmdJUi
2. **GHOne TV Interview:** David Kpondehou & Terry Otieno represented the TICAD Youth Initiative in the TV interview on 10 August 2026. https://x.com/ghonetv/status/2086714380360851477 (direct cut out): https://youtu.be/rI9EgYzfMh8?si=lHcpKETGIbCeVuuh
3. **Radio Interview:** ChannelAfrica. David Kpondehou was interviewed. https://youtu.be/A3ByIUmA4po?si=oFFa-QpMl8z4Ut42
4. **News Articles:**

Arhinful, E. (2026, July 28). Ghana to host major international youth platforms during National Youth Month – Osman Ayariga. Adomonline. https://www.adomonline.com/ghana-to-host-major-international-youth-platforms-during-national-youth-month-osman-ayariga/

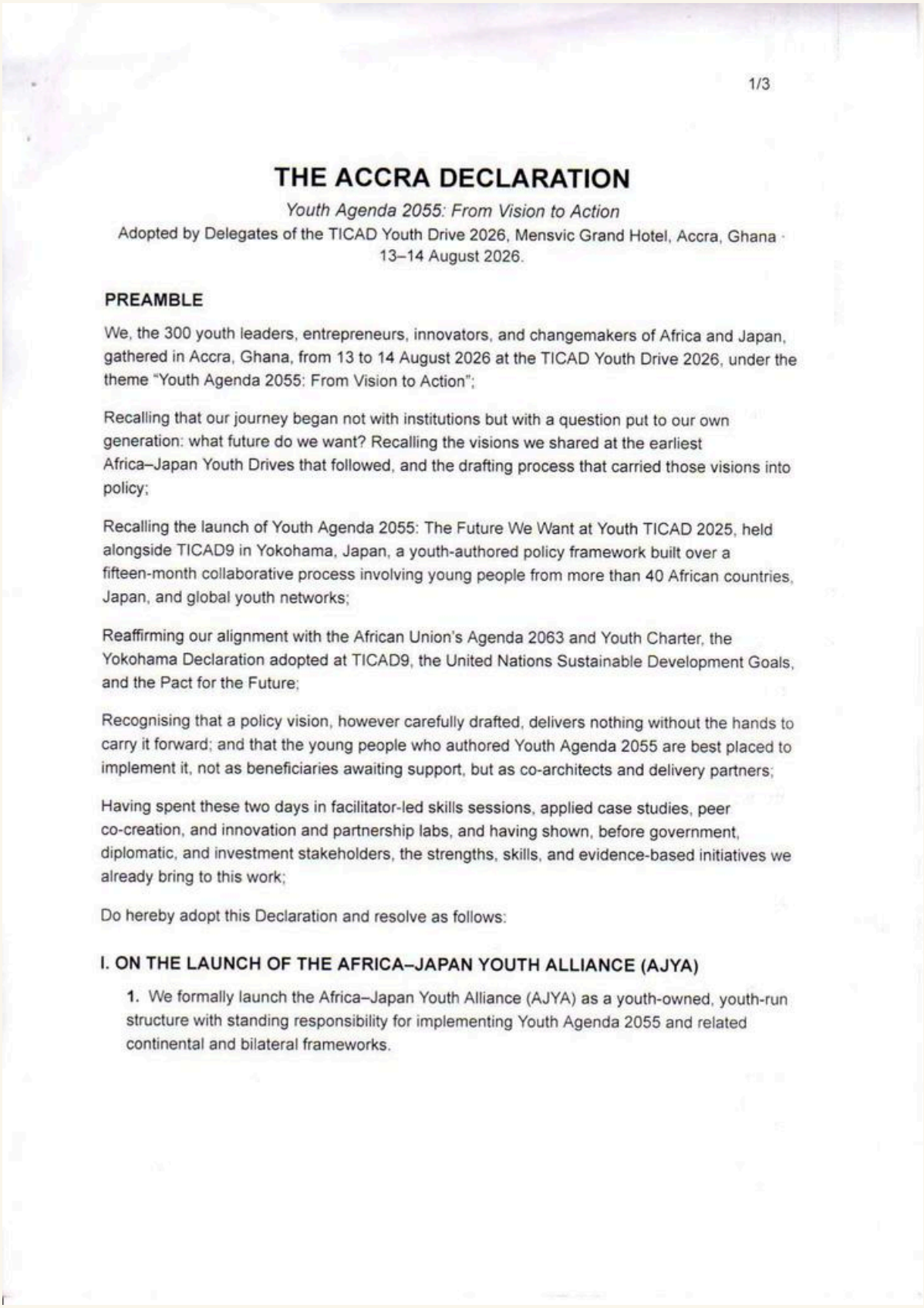
The world will need Africa's resources and young population – Prof Ikegame. (2026, August 17). Ghana Business News. https://www.ghanabusinessnews.com/2026/08/17/the-world-will-need-africas-resources-and-young-population-prof-ikegame/

Africa and Japan's young leaders stop waiting to be invited and launch their own alliance to implement the "Youth Agenda 2055". (2026). https://www.businessghana.com/site/news/business/354410/Africa-and-Japan

Japan deepening Africa's relations via strong youth agenda. (2026). Frontier Africa Reports. https://news.frontierafricareports.com/article/japan-deepening-africas-relations-via-strong-youth-agenda

The Accra Declaration

Adopted by delegates of the TICAD Youth Drive 2026 on 13 August 2026, the Accra Declaration is the Drive's formal policy outcome, titled 'The Accra Declaration: Youth Agenda 2055, From Vision to Action.' Signed on stage by the Pan-African Youth Union, AAYN, and ADNJ, the Declaration is intended to serve as the policy engine carrying young people's call to action to the African Union, TICAD co-organizers, and global partners including the World Bank, JICA, and UNDP, ahead of the TICAD Ministerial Conference and TICAD10.



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THE ACCRA DECLARATION

Youth Agenda 2055: From Vision to Action

Adopted by Delegates of the TICAD Youth Drive 2026, Mensvic Grand Hotel, Accra, Ghana · 13–14 August 2026.

PREAMBLE

We, the 300 youth leaders, entrepreneurs, innovators, and changemakers of Africa and Japan, gathered in Accra, Ghana, from 13 to 14 August 2026 at the TICAD Youth Drive 2026, under the theme "Youth Agenda 2055: From Vision to Action";

Recalling that our journey began not with institutions but with a question put to our own generation: what future do we want? Recalling the visions we shared at the earliest Africa–Japan Youth Drives that followed, and the drafting process that carried those visions into policy;

Recalling the launch of Youth Agenda 2055: The Future We Want at Youth TICAD 2025, held alongside TICAD9 in Yokohama, Japan, a youth-authored policy framework built over a fifteen-month collaborative process involving young people from more than 40 African countries, Japan, and global youth networks;

Reaffirming our alignment with the African Union's Agenda 2063 and Youth Charter, the Yokohama Declaration adopted at TICAD9, the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, and the Pact for the Future;

Recognising that a policy vision, however carefully drafted, delivers nothing without the hands to carry it forward; and that the young people who authored Youth Agenda 2055 are best placed to implement it, not as beneficiaries awaiting support, but as co-architects and delivery partners;

Having spent these two days in facilitator-led skills sessions, applied case studies, peer co-creation, and innovation and partnership labs, and having shown, before government, diplomatic, and investment stakeholders, the strengths, skills, and evidence-based initiatives we already bring to this work;

Do hereby adopt this Declaration and resolve as follows:

I. ON THE LAUNCH OF THE AFRICA–JAPAN YOUTH ALLIANCE (AJYA)

1. We formally launch the Africa–Japan Youth Alliance (AJYA) as a youth-owned, youth-run structure with standing responsibility for implementing Youth Agenda 2055 and related continental and bilateral frameworks.

2. The AJYA is designed and driven by young people ourselves. We are not asking larger, more established organisations to lead this work on our behalf; we are building the alliance that will lead it.

3. We commit to establishing the AJYA's founding structure: including regional representation across Africa and Japan, rotating leadership with defined terms, and thematic working groups aligned to the pillars of Youth Agenda 2055 — in the twelve months following this Declaration.

II. ON YOUTH AGENDA 2055: FROM VISION TO ACTION

4. We reaffirm our commitment to the three pillars of Youth Agenda 2055: Society, Economy, and Peace & Governance, and to its two cross-cutting enablers: People-to-People Relationships between Africa and Japan, and Climate Resilience & Sustainability.

5. We commit to translating the ten Actions of Youth Agenda 2055 into concrete, monitored workplans, beginning with the priorities identified during this Drive's working sessions.

III. ON CAPACITY AND CO-CREATION

6. We affirm that young people already possess the skills, evidence, and initiatives needed to implement development priorities today, not at some future point once capacity has been built for us, but now, alongside continued investment in our growth.

7. We commit to sustaining the peer-to-peer skills-sharing, mentoring, and co-creation models piloted at this Drive, and to extending them through the AJYA's digital and regional structures.

IV. CALLS TO ACTION

8. To the African Union: help institutionalise Youth Agenda 2055: The Future We Want, so that all African Union member states can formally recognise it and support its implementation, and, in doing so, recognise the AJYA as its implementing hand on the continent.

9. To TICAD Co-organizers: formally recognise the AJYA as the TICAD Youth Advisory Board and factor it into TICAD's funding structures, so that its activities can be reviewed and funded on the same footing as other TICAD projects; and reflect that recognition in TICAD's own proceedings, through seats, speaker slots, and dedicated space for the AJYA in plenaries and official sessions.

10. To the Private Sector and Development Partners: reach out to the AJYA directly, work with us as partners rather than beneficiaries, and commit funding, mentorship, and market access to the AJYA and its founding initiatives, including through the global fundraising and project verification functions of the TICAD Youth Foundation.

11. To Civil Society and Media: amplify youth-led outcomes from this Drive and hold all stakeholders, including ourselves, accountable for the commitments made here.

V. OUR COMMITMENTS

12. We commit to reconvene, through the AJYA fora, to report publicly on progress against this Declaration, in line with the monitoring and evaluation framework set out in Youth Agenda 2055: The Future We Want.

13. We commit to inclusion in our own structures, ensuring representation from rural and underserved communities, women, and marginalised groups across the AJYA's leadership and working groups.

14. We commit to carrying this Declaration beyond Accra: into national youth platforms, regional forums, and the next TICAD Youth Drive and conference, so that the future we want continues to be a future we build.

ADOPTION

Adopted by acclamation by the delegates of the TICAD Youth Drive 2026, Mensvic Grand Hotel, Accra, Ghana, this 14th day of August 2026.

On behalf of the youth delegates of the TICAD Youth Drive 2026:

African Diaspora Network Japan (ADNJ):

1. David Kpondehou - President, ADNJ.
2. Terry Otieno - Policy Lead, ADNJ.

Africa Asia Youth Nest (AAYN):

3. Yuki Yasumiba - Co-founder, AAYN.
4. Ami Nishijima - Co-founder, AAYN.

Pan Africa Union (PYU):

5. Moumouni Dialla - President, PYU.

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Partners and Supporting Organizations

The TICAD Youth Drive 2026 was made possible through the support and partnership of the following organizations:

Nationalities of the TICAD Youth Drive 2026 Delegates

- Benin
- Burkina Faso
- Burundi
- Cameroon
- Central African Republic
- Chad
- DRC Congo
- Côte d'Ivoire
- Djibouti
- Ethiopia
- Ghana
- Gabon
- Guinea-Bissau
- Japan
- Kenya
- Liberia
- Malawi
- Nigeria
- Rwanda
- Somalia
- South Sudan
- Togo
- Zimbabwe



TICAD Youth Drive 2026 Organizing Committee Members

- David Kpondehou
- Terry Otieno
- Yasumiba Yuki
- Ami Nishijima
- Apedoh Angela Akorfa
- Jonathan Addey (LONA)
- Ahorlu Delali Florence
- Selma Yoda
- Fuma Tanaka
- Caroline Awuye
- Hiroshi Yokoyama
- Wiem Chamsi
- Winnie Karugi
- Marina Noda
- Jewel Hatta
- Kotone Sakamoto
- Mex Ntoutoume
- Debrah Nana Yaw Sarfo
- Mio Yuki



TICAD Youth Drive 2026 Report.



ADNJ
AFRICA DIASPORA NETWORK JAPAN

Africa Asia Youth Nest

TICAD YOUTH DRIVE 2026